

Ariel Mundo Ortiz

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Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Research Assistant (J0426-0635) position in the Leung Lab at the RI-MUHC. Dr. Leung's work on biomarkers for cervical pre-cancer and cancer, including circulating tumor DNA detection, closely aligns with my background in preclinical cancer research and clinical research. Her recent work examining HPV ctDNA as a response biomarker in metastatic cervical cancer is the kind of clinically relevant, translational science I am eager to support. My experience in health data analysis, clinical research, and manuscript preparation makes me a strong candidate for this role.

In my current postdoctoral position at CRCHUM, I work directly with electronic health records and large clinical datasets. I build data pipelines, apply appropriate statistical methods for analysis, produce data visualizations, and write manuscripts. This work requires close collaboration with clinicians and research teams, and careful management of ethics-related administrative requirements. These are precisely the duties described in the Leung Lab position, and I am confident I can significantly contribute from day one due to my doctoral training in cancer research.

My project management experience spans multiple funded research programs. I have been a co-investigator on a CIHR grant totalling CAD 412,000, contributing to proposal writing, literature review, and team coordination. Earlier, I was the lead author on a seed grant that ranked in the top 2 of all submissions at the University of Arkansas. Managing timelines, coordinating collaborators, and meeting reporting requirements are responsibilities I have handled across all my positions.

I am bilingual in English and French, with full professional competency in both languages. I also bring experience writing and revising peer-reviewed manuscripts, working within HPC environments, and using R and Git for reproducible analysis workflows. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background fits the needs of the Leung Lab. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Ariel Mundo Ortiz